An inner voice told me that the time had come for a long felt, but ignored, need for renewal. Let me clean my slate and write new ‘sums’. Were the earlier sums done correctly? Evaluating one’s own progress in life is not an easy task. Here the student has to set his own questions, seek his own answers and evaluate them to his own satisfaction. Judgement aside, eighteen years at ISRO was too long a stay to leave without pain. As for my afflicted friends, the lines by Lewis Carrol seemed very appropriate:

*You may charge me with murder –*

*Or want of sense*

*(We are all of us weak at times):*

*But the slightest approach to a false pretence*

*Was never among my crimes!*

* * *

**III**

**PROPITIATION**

**[ 1981 – 1991 ]**

*Let craft, ambition, spite,*

*Be quenched in Reason’s night, Till weakness turn to might,*